



Muncie Ethics Commission - March 11, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SbKbeDuEr94
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Ethics Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 11, Wednesday, 6:00 PM

Location: Muny Sanitary District Office

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Ethics Commission was called to order by the presiding officer at 6:03 PM on Wednesday, March 11.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Susan Dylan, Jim Low, Chip Taylor, Sandra Whitaker
 - **Absent:** Frank Scott
 - **Presiding Officer:** Susan Dylan (Chair)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Approval of Minutes:** [00:00:47](#) The minutes from the January meeting were reviewed by the commissioners. A motion was made and seconded to approve the minutes as presented. The minutes were **Approved by Voice Vote**.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:49 Item 1: Review and Adoption of Advisory Opinion on Employee Gifts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Susan Dylan, Commission Chair (in collaboration with legal counsel and the Human Resources department).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission discussed an informal inquiry it recently received regarding a significant gift given to a city department in appreciation for work performed as part of normal duties. Because the high-value gift exceeded legal allowances, the department head withheld distribution and consulted the commission. The commission formulated its very first formal advisory opinion to clarify ordinance rules surrounding gifts, establishing clear definitions for “nominal” and “de minimis” gifts (defining nominal gifts valued at \$20 to \$25, and de minimis items as small tokens like a notepad, pen, or cup of coffee). Commissioners praised the department head for handling the situation correctly and noted that the HR director coordinated with the commission to ensure alignment with staff training and city policies.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** A motion was made and seconded to adopt the advisory opinion. **Approved by Voice Vote.**

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No open public comment period or general citizen forum was held during this meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** **00:08:55** The next regular meeting of the Ethics Commission is scheduled for **April 8** at 6:00 PM at the Muny Sanitary District office, pending any changes that would be publicly posted.
- **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote** (meeting concluded following the voice vote at approximately **00:09:50**).

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